i. Both the vernacular and national press in India needed to exercise restraint in their news coverage, which could help to maintain communal harmony in Punjab and also among the Punjabi diaspora in the US and Canada.
ii. The activities of Bhindranwale, who appeared to be enjoying political patronage, needed to be curbed and controlled.
iii. Visits by US- or Canada-based pro-Khalistan ideologues to India, and specifically to Punjab, needed to be stopped.
iv. Senior Akali Dal leaders needed to be told that granthis and sewadars coming from Punjab had to be properly screened before they were sent to the US/Canada for manning gurudwaras, to avoid spawning anti-India sentiments in those countries.
v. Some senior Congress and Akali Dal leaders needed to visit their areas, openly and not quietly, to meet local Punjabi immigrants to assure them that everything in Punjab was fine and that they would do everything possible to bring normalcy back to Punjab.
vi. Indian missions located in their respective areas needed to hold or encourage joint meetings of prominent Hindus and Sikhs, to restore mutual trust between the two communities.

A note ignored

I left Los Angeles for Tokyo on Christmas eve. After spending a day there I returned to New Delhi on 26 December 1981. Taking advantage of the long trans-Pacific flight from Los Angeles to Tokyo, I prepared a short note on my visit to the US and Canada. I met Suntook on 27 December and discussed with him the inputs I had gathered during my trip. He asked me to prepare a short one-page point-wise handwritten note and show it to Senior Advisor Kao the same afternoon.

As directed, I prepared the note and handed it to Kao at his Rashtrapati Bhavan office. After going through the note carefully, to my surprise, he asked me to meet the prime minister's principal